Francy D. Luna Diaz

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EDUCATION

University of Michigan Expected May 2027
Ph.D., Political Science
Dissertation Committee: Nicholas Valentino (Chair), Ted Brader, Mara Ostfeld, Yanna Krupnikov, Charles Shipan

University of Arizona May 2019
B.A., Political Science, B.A., Law
4.00 GPA, *summa cum laude*, Highest Honors

Pima Community College May 2016
A.A., Political Science
4.00 GPA, Highest Honors

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political psychology, political behavior, political communication, public opinion, transnationalism, social media, misinformation, Latino politics, mixed methods.

DISSERTATION

Book-Style: "Rumors Across Borders: The Influence of Transnational Ties on Latinos' Information Environment."

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

"Women 'doing' the judiciary: Rethinking the justice argument for descriptive representation." (With Suzanne Dovi), 2020. *Politics, Groups, and Identities*, 8(4), 790–802. Dialogues Paper, Routledge. https://doi.org/10.1080/21565503.2020.1789882

Public Scholarship

"Some Findings about the Nature and Distribution of American Stereotypes About Americans: Evidence from a 2024 US Survey." (with Mark Tessler and Amnon Cavari), 2025. *Center for Political Studies Blog*. Research Brief. Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Center for Political Studies, Institute for Social Research. https://cpsblog.isr.umich.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/10/American-Stereotypes-1025-Remediated.pdf

"Latinos for Trump in 2020." (with Tevah Platt), 2022. *Center for Political Studies Blog*. Blog. Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Center for Political Studies, Institute for Social Research. https://cpsblog.isr.umich.edu/?p=3106

UNDER PEER REVIEW

"Rumors Across Borders: How Transnational Ties and Social Media Shape Latino Belief in Misinformation and Support for Trump." (Solo author)

"Mobilizing Anger in Local School Board Politics" (with Hilary Izatt and Zoe C. Walker).

WORKING PAPERS

"What Changed? Predictors of the Latino Vote Shift During the Trump Era" (with Mario Villegas, Franshelly Martinez-Ortiz, and Nicholas Valentino).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Lost in Translation: Language and Perception of Misinformation for Latinos in the U.S." (with Franshelly Martinez-Ortiz).

"Threats Against Democracy, Anger, and Mobilization for the 2024 Presidential Election" (with Nicholas Valentino and Hilary Izatt).

"Effect of Racial Labels on Survey Responses" (with Sunshine Hillygus and Nicholas Valentino).

"The rACE Coding Scheme: Measuring Racial Attribution, Color-Blindness, and Explicitness in Open-Ended Survey Responses."

"Conspiratorial Thinking and Anti-Semitism, Islamophobia, and Anti-Black Sentiment in the U.S." (with Mark Tessler and Amnon Cavari).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

"Rumors Across Borders: The Impact of Transnational Ties on Latino Information Environments and Political Attitudes." 2026. International Society of Political Psychology Annual Meeting

"Mobilizing Anger in Local School Board Politics." 2026. Invited to present at Midwest Political Science Association.

"Predictors of Latino Vote Shifts toward Trump from 2020 to 2024: Sexism, Material Self-Interest, or Immigrant Crime Threats?" 2026. Midwest Political Science Association

"Rumors Across Borders: The Impact of Transnational Ties on Latino Information Environments and Political Attitudes." 2024. Presented at PRIEC UT Austin, PRIEC MSU, Western Political Science Association Latina/o/x Politics Workshop, Midwest Political Science Association, International Society of Political Psychology, and American Political Science Association Annual Meeting.

"Lost in Translation: Language and Perception of Misinformation for Latinos in the U.S." 2024. Presented at the International Society of Political Psychology and American Political Science Association Annual Meeting.

"Latinos for Trump in 2020: A Story of Heterogeneous Information Environments and Social Media." 2023. Presented at Western Political Science Association Latina/o/x Politics Workshop, Midwest Political Science Association, and International Society of Political Psychology.

"In Their Own Words: Latino Vote and Preference for the 2016 and 2020 Presidential Elections." 2022. Presented at International Society of Political Psychology Annual Meeting and American Political Science Association Annual Meeting.

TEACHING

Voting and Race in American Politics, Grader (Fall 2026)
Instructor: Nazita Lajevardi.

Congress and the Presidency, Graduate Student Instructor (Fall 2025, Spring 2026)
Instructor: Lynn Rivers.

Congress and the Presidency, Grader (Spring 2023 to Spring 2025)
Instructor: Lynn Rivers.

The Legislative Process, Graduate Student Instructor (Spring 2021)
Instructor: Christian Fong.

Introduction to American Politics, Graduate Student Instructor (Fall 2020)
Instructor: Charles Shipan.

INVITED TALKS AND LECTURES

Stonehill College, Intro to American Politics, Professor Guillermo Caballero (October 2024)

Binghamton University (SUNY), Research Laboratory, Professor Hilary Izatt (September 2024)

University of Massachusetts Amherst, Survey Methods Graduate Seminar, Professor Alexander Theodoridis (April 2023)

SELECTED GRANTS

Individual

NSF APSA DDRIG *Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant*, $15,000 (2025-2026)

CEW+ Center for the Education of Women, *Career Development Grant*, $2,000 (2026)

University of Michigan, *Rackham Graduate Research Grant*, $3,000 (2024)

American Political Science Association, *Fund for Latino Scholarship Grant*, $1,500 (2024)

American Political Science Association, *First Generation Scholar Grant* (2022)

Co-Authored

American Political Science Association, *Spring Centennial Grant*, $2,500 (2024)

National Center for Institutional Diversity, Rackham Graduate School, and the Center for Racial Justice at the Gerald R. Ford School of Public Policy, *Anti-Racism Graduate Research Grant*, $15,000 (2023)

American Political Science Association, *Spring Centennial Grant*, $2,500 (2023)

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

NSF

NSF GRFP National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship (2021-2026)

University of Michigan

Rackham Merit Fellowship (2019-2026)

CEW+ Center for the Education of Women+, Gutsy Broad Fund Fellowship (2025)

Garth Taylor Fellowship in Public Opinion (2025)

Hanes Walton Jr. Fellowship for Graduate Study in Racial and Ethnic Politics (2024)

Philip Converse and Warren Miller Fellowship in American Political Behavior (2023)

American Political Science Association

APSA Diversity Fellowship (2020)

Other

AAPOR American Association for Public Opinion Research, *Student-Faculty Diversity Pipeline Award* (2024)

University of Arizona *Robie Gold Medal Award* (2019)

University of Arizona *Honors College Outstanding Senior* (2019)

University of Arizona UROP Undergraduate Research Opportunity Program Scholar (2018)

Pima Community College Commencement Speaker (2016)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, ANES American National Election Studies. Current.

Graduate Research Assistant, Professors Mark Tessler and Amnon Cavari (2024)

Graduate Research Assistant, Professor Ted Brader (2020)

Graduate Research Assistant, Professor Charles Shipan (2020)

Undergraduate Research Assistant, Professors Javier Osorio and Susan Brewer-Osorio (2018 to 2019)

Undergraduate Research Assistant, Professor Suzanne Dovi (2017)

Research Fellow, Undergraduate Research Opportunity Consortium, Professor Samara Klar (2017)

SERVICE

Panel Discussant, American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2026)

Article Reviewer, American Journal of Political Science (2026)

Leader, Dissertation Writing Workshop, Rackham Graduate School (2026)

Reader, Undergraduate Honors Thesis Review Committee, Department of Political Science (2021, 2024, 2026)

Lead Coordinator, Interdisciplinary Race and Ethnic Politics Research Workshop, Rackham Graduate School (2022 to 2024)

Hiring Committee Member, Faculty Search for the Political Science Methodology Subfield, Department of Political Science (2023)

Application Reviewer, Master of Data Science Program, Department of Statistics (2023, 2024, 2025)

Admissions Assistant, Emerging Scholars Conference, Department of Political Science (2022, 2024)

Coordinator, Interdisciplinary Workshop in American Politics, Rackham Graduate School (2021, 2022)

Committee Member, Graduate Student Admissions for the American Politics Subfield, Department of Political Science (2021)

MENTORSHIP & RESEARCH SUPERVISION

Undergraduate Research Supervisor (2023-2026)

Graduate Student Mentor (2020-2023)

Fellowship Application Mentor (2021, 2022, 2026)

METHODS TRAINING

Advanced Quantitative Methods. Instructor: Walter Mebane (Fall 2021)

Behavioral Research Methods. Instructor: Nicholas Valentino (Fall 2021)

Statistics Methods Research II. Instructor: Kevin Quinn (Winter 2020)

Statistics Methods Research I. Instructor: Yuki Shiraito (Fall 2020).

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

American Political Science Association
Midwest Political Science Association
International Society of Political Psychology
International Political Science Association
American Association for Public Opinion Research

SKILLS

Research Methods: Survey research design, survey experiments, causal mediation analysis, mixed-methods research, qualitative interviews, and content analysis.

Computational Methods: Structural topic modeling, computational text analysis, and LLM-assisted text classification.

Software: R, Stata, Qualtrics, LaTeX, Dedoose, Git/GitHub.

Languages: English (Native), Spanish (Native).